Chapter 10

Koverau, kururu, koopu – Three kinds of bamboo

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(a) (b) (c)

Figure 1: (a) *Koverau*, (b) *Kururu*, (c) *Koopu*

Figure 2: *Koverau*

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Figure 3: *Makaree* – Fishing spear called *makaree*

(1)	*O koverau na pura nana rasuu.*	The *koverau* bamboo grows in the jungle.
(2)	*O* koverau *saka tau pura vatotobin tamuana bata haana.*	The *koverau* bamboo might not always grow straight.
(3)	*Tau hoa vanaavihu batana bara tau obete gunaha suku batana bona maa hum gunaha.*	It might grow in the opposite direction and lie on the ground following the slope of a mountain downward.
(4)	*Ei be pura tea maa vaereere.*	This means that it grows on the edges of mountains.
(5)	*Pura vageegeno batari amaa meha.*	Some grow crooked.
(6)	*O koverau na vaarutaa ki nana bono kururu.*	The *koverau* bamboo is smaller than the *kururu* bamboo.
(7)	*O naono o mataa, na paku raara bono tahitahi.*	It is a good plant, we make spears (from it).
(8)	*Bea otei tau nao tea mosi koverau,*	When a man is about to cut *koverau* bamboos,
(9)	*toro tara vamataa kurus maa bona maa aba vai*	he must have a very good look at the ones
(10)	*to pasi mosi maa nae mene o makaree teve.*	that he will cut for his fishing spear.
(11)	*Be dee voosu maa bona dee koverau teve,*	When he brings his load of *koverau* bamboos home,
(12)	*ore paa vaasun bona matana inu teori,*	he stands them up in front of their house,
(13)	*ei ore roava nana.*	so that they are exposed to the sun.

(14)	*Be mahaka, ore paa aeae, ore paa nana mana bari teo suraa.*	When they dry up, they become light, and then they (the men) warm them over the fire.
(15)	*Pasi nana bata nom ori, beori menamenaa vaatotobin batari bari.*	They will warm them, while they are bending them straight.
(16)	*Beve totobin, ore paa kahu bono kosi no koverau,*	When they (the bamboos) are straight, they scrape the bottom of the *koverau* bamboos,
(17)	*vaamatatopo vo tea vaatopo bono kuna sikiri.*	and prepare them for sticking the spikes (into them).
(18)	*Vaatopo vai bona maa kuna sikiri,*	Now they stick in the spikes,
(19)	*ore paa pam bari bona kanono.*	and fasten them with a string.
(20)	*Be kavara, erau are paa pokaa e bono makaree.*	When this is finished, then we call it *makaree* 'fishing spear'.
(21)	*Bea abana nao tahii, toro ato momohu tea makaree teori mene tahi vamate bona iana vai a beera to pasi rahi riori tea kanono.*	When the men go fishing, they must first get their fishing spears for spearing a big fish to death that they will pull (out of the water) with a string.

Figure 4: *Ato teo makaree* – Holding the *makaree* spear

Figure 5: *Kururu*

(22)	*O kururu na vaapeha mi nana bono koverau.*	The *kururu* bamboo is similar to the *koverau* bamboo.
(23)	*Amaa naono vai to tei me rori bona maa navanava riori: koverau, kururu, koopu, tovu, tabuana.*	The plants that have bars (separated by knots) are: the *koverau*, *kururu* and *koopu* bamboos, the *tovu* sugar cane and the wild sugar cane.
(24)	*O kururu na isuisuvu ruene ni riori mee.*	The *kururu* bamboo is used for fetching water.
(25)	*Beori tau isuvu ruene ni bari, na dona rori bona kukan a nava kuruu.*	When they are going to fetch water with it, they pierce (the knots between) three bars.
(26)	*Murinae, eori repaa gono bene ta naono eta bebeahu bara kikis*	For this they get a long and strong stick
(27)	*to tahitahi nibusu nao riori bona buaku a nava kururu vaa gina,*	with which they pierce holes into the knots of the two top *kururu* bars,
(28)	*beori goe bona nava vaa taeno kuruu.*	while leaving the bar at the bottom of the *kururu* bamboo intact.
(29)	*A ruene re goe tea oro tavusu.*	Then the water would not flow out.
(30)	*O koopu saka pura vamataa haana rapana kasuana ge tea suiri,*	The *koopu* bamboo does not grow well near the beach or in the lowlands,
(31)	*na pura vamataa nana tea voora.*	it grows well in the mountains.
(32)	*Meha maa vuri a ta vaan vai to tei rori tea maa vaan vahiava na vaamahaka rori bona tabaan teori komano koopu.*	Sometimes the people who live in the mountain villages cook their food in the *koopu* bamboo.
(33)	*Na mosi maari bona maa nava koopu,*	They cut some bars of *koopu* bamboo,

(a) (b)

Figure 6: (a) *Koopu*, (b) *Taboo a inu* – Walling a house

(34)	*eori repaa apeo bona tabaan tabae to rake riori tea apeo: e guu, manii, kaukau, gea tabae to rake riori tea an.*	and then they cook in the bamboo whatever food they like to cook in the bamboo: pork, possum, sweet potatoes or what they like to eat.
(35)	*O koopu vai o peree to apeo riori bona tabaan.*	It is the green *koopu* bamboo in which they cook the food.
(36)	*Eori repaa vaamahaka bari teo suraa.*	Then they let it simmer on the fire.
(37)	*Beori vaatoka bono koopu teo suraa,*	When they put the *koopu* bamboo onto the fire,
(38)	*toro vavereverete bata ni rori bono koopu to mene asi.*	they must repeatedly turn the *koopu* bamboo around so that it won't burn.
(39)	*Eara na voni rara a koopu tea ta vahiava mene paku bono takinima na maa inu teara.*	We buy the *koopu* bamboo from the mountain people to make the walls of our houses.
(40)	*Beara taboo a inu teara bono takinima ore paa tara vamataa.*	When we wall our house with bamboo walls, it looks beautiful.[1]

[1]See Chapter 19.